

August 2026

**Dear Clifford R,**

I've worked this stretch of Lafayette for a long time, and the homes along Walnut Lane have always stood out to me for exactly the kind of thing your property delivers: a serious lot, real privacy, and a setting that feels removed from the noise without being far from anything. The combination of mature oaks, park-like grounds, and a cul-de-sac position is genuinely rare at any price point. When I saw the listing come off the market at 69 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out, because in my view the home's fundamentals and the outcome simply don't add up.

What the listing history tells me is that buyers weren't given the full picture. A farmhouse-style home on a half-acre lot with updated chef's kitchen, four bedrooms, and indoor-outdoor flow to gardens, patios, and a deck at \$1,995,000 is a compelling offering in Lafayette. But at \$904 per square foot, which sits at the upper tier of the Lafayette premium range, buyers need a fully built case before they'll walk in the door. The listing description made the right moves in spirit, but it leaned on phrases like 'seamlessly' and 'effortless entertaining' when buyers at this price point are comparison-shopping carefully. The grounds, the oak canopy, the views, the cul-de-sac privacy, and the trail access to Las Trampas and the Lafayette-Orinda Trail deserved to be the headline, not a footnote near the bottom of the remarks.

I've put together a short packet that walks through the three specific gaps I see between this home's actual value and how the listing presented it, along with how I'd approach a relaunch differently. There's no obligation attached to it. I just think you deserve a clear read on what happened and what a better strategy would look like.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside with my compliments. If you're not, I'd welcome a conversation whenever the timing feels right for you.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Ben Olsen", with a long horizontal line extending to the right.

**Ben Olsen**

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*The Path to Sold:*

# 3348 Walnut Ln

Lafayette, CA 94549

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**4.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 2,208 Sq Ft · Lafayette**

*The Blueprint for a Successful Sale*

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**Prepared For:** The Owners of 3348 Walnut Ln

**Presented By:** Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

# A Park-Like Half-Acre with Farmhouse Character - and a Listing That Left the Story Half-Told

3348 Walnut Lane sits on 21,340 square feet of oak-canopied grounds on a quiet Lafayette cul-de-sac, with four bedrooms, three bathrooms, a chef's kitchen with breakfast bar, wood-burning fireplace, custom built-ins, and multiple access points opening to gardens, patios, and a deck. The trail proximity to Las Trampas Swim Club and the Lafayette-Orinda Trail, combined with top-rated Lafayette schools, puts this home in the conversation for exactly the buyers who move from San Francisco and Oakland specifically for this kind of lifestyle. These are real, marketable assets. The kind that support a premium price when the marketing does its job.

At \$904 per square foot on a 69-day listing that ended without a sale, the gap between the fundamentals and the outcome points to a strategy problem, not a property problem. The listing description touched on the right features but never built the argument for the price. Buyers comparing at this level need to understand what they're getting that they can't find elsewhere, specifically the lot size, the privacy, the setting, and the lifestyle access. Without that case built clearly in the marketing, buyers at \$1,995,000 moved on before scheduling a showing.

**\$1,995,000**

List Price

**\$904/sqft**

Price Per Sq. Ft.

**None**

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to lead with what actually differentiates this property: the grounds, the oaks, the cul-de-sac privacy, and the trail and community access that Lafayette buyers at this price range are specifically looking for. The kitchen and interior updates support the number. The setting justifies it.

## MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

### Friction #1: 69 Days Without a Strategy Shift

After 69 days on the market, buyer psychology had already done its damage. Past the 45-day mark, buyers stop asking whether a home is worth the price and start asking what everyone else noticed that they might have missed. At \$1,995,000 in Lafayette, that skepticism is costly. The buyers who could afford this home and had the most interest likely saw it in the first three weeks. The remaining six weeks weren't generating new demand, they were confirming doubt. The strategy didn't adapt, and the listing eventually came off the market without a sale or a visible pivot.

#### \* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

*BrightWork uses the Final Offer platform to surface real buyer demand in a structured, transparent format, so sellers can see exactly where interest stands and make informed decisions before the clock runs out on the listing period.*

### Friction #2: \$904/Sqft With a Case That Was Never Made

At \$904 per square foot, this home is priced at the upper end of the Lafayette premium range. That number is defensible. The half-acre lot, the park-like grounds, the mature oak canopy, the cul-de-sac position, and the proximity to Las Trampas and the Lafayette-Orinda Trail all support a premium. But buyers doing side-by-side comparisons on Zillow and homes.com need to understand specifically what they're getting at that number. The listing description leaned on adjectives rather than differentiation. Words like 'fabulous,' 'seamlessly,' and 'beautifully reimaged' appear where concrete details about the setting, the lot, and the lifestyle access should have been. Buyers at this price point are careful. They need to be convinced before they drive out.

#### \* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

*BrightWork's homes.com premium membership delivers significantly higher view counts and broader distribution than a standard agent account, putting this property in front of buyers who are actively researching Lafayette before they've found what they're looking for.*

### Friction #3: The Outdoor Setting Was a Footnote, Not the Story

A 21,340-square-foot lot with majestic oaks, meandering pathways, multiple patio and deck spaces, and picturesque views is the kind of asset that Lafayette buyers at \$1,995,000 specifically come looking for. It's not a supporting detail. It's the reason someone chooses this home over a newer, smaller-lot alternative nearby. Standard MLS photography almost never captures what a lot like this actually feels like. Ground-level angles, flat lighting, and a quick pass through the yard leave the canopy, the sense of scale, and the privacy completely invisible to online buyers. This setting needed to be the first thing buyers experienced, not the last paragraph of the listing remarks.

#### \* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

*BrightWork's Sky Tour captures the lot position, oak canopy, and park-like setting from above in a way that no ground photography or satellite image can replicate, giving buyers the visual depth to understand what they're getting before they ever schedule a showing.*

## POSITIONING ANALYSIS

| Metric                  | 3348 Walnut Ln                                                                                                      | Lafayette Market Context                               |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Price per Sq. Ft.       | <b>\$904/sqft</b>                                                                                                   | Premium tier: \$850–\$920/sqft                         |
| Lot / Setting           | <b>21,340 sqft, cul-de-sac, oak canopy, park-like grounds</b>                                                       | Typical Lafayette lot: 8,000–12,000 sqft               |
| Architectural Character | <b>Farmhouse style, high-quality updates, custom built-ins, wood-burning fireplace</b>                              | Standard 1960s–1970s updated ranch or split-level      |
| Premium Features        | <b>Chef's kitchen with breakfast bar, indoor-outdoor flow, multiple patios and deck, trail and swim club access</b> | Standard floor plan, basic outdoor space               |
| HOA                     | <b>None</b>                                                                                                         | Varies; most Lafayette single-family homes have no HOA |

**The verdict:** At \$904/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$850-\$920/sqft, this home sits near the upper end of that range. At \$904 per square foot, this home sits near the upper end of Lafayette's premium range. The lot size, setting, and architectural updates support that position. What the listing period revealed is that buyers weren't given the tools to see the case clearly, especially the outdoor setting and lifestyle access that separate this property from comparably priced homes on smaller lots. A relaunch built around those differentiators, with media that actually shows the grounds, gives this home a much stronger chance of landing where the fundamentals say it should.

## THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

### Pillar I - Build the Visual Case for the Lot Before a Buyer Drives Out

The 21,340-square-foot setting with mature oaks, pathways, and multi-level outdoor spaces is the most compelling differentiator this home has. It's also the asset most invisible in standard MLS photography. A relaunch starts with media that does the setting justice, including aerial coverage that shows the lot scale, canopy, and cul-de-sac position in a way buyers can actually feel. BrightWork's Sky Tour is purpose-built for exactly this kind of property. When buyers can experience the grounds from above before they ever schedule a showing, the in-person visit confirms rather than discovers.

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## **Pillar II - Write a Listing Description That Earns the Price**

At \$904 per square foot, buyers are doing careful comparisons, and the listing remarks are often the deciding factor in whether a showing gets scheduled at all. The previous description had the right instincts but relied on adjectives where specific detail was needed. A relaunched listing leads with the cul-de-sac privacy, the trail access to Las Trampas and the Lafayette-Orinda Trail, the half-acre park-like grounds, and the community context that Lafayette families at this price range are specifically seeking. BrightWork's listing narrative is written the way a great buyer's agent describes a home to a motivated client, because that's who reads it first.

## **Pillar III - Put This Home in Front of the Right Buyer Pool Before They Find Something Else**

The buyers most likely to pay \$1,995,000 for this property are relocating from San Francisco or Oakland, shopping online first and hard, and looking for exactly the combination of lot size, trail access, and top schools that Walnut Lane delivers. Waiting for them to stumble onto a standard MLS listing isn't a strategy. BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns reach those buyers while they are actively researching Lafayette, before they have found what they are looking for. Combined with the off-market private buyer list at [offmarket.brightworkrealty.com](http://offmarket.brightworkrealty.com), this home gets seen by the right people at the right moment.

## A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

# Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- \* **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- \* **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- \* **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

### \* HOW IT WORKS

*We alert our private buyer list through [offmarket.brightworkrealty.com](https://offmarket.brightworkrealty.com) - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.*

## TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

### Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

### Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

### Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

### Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

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#### WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- \* **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- \* **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- \* **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- \* **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- \* **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

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This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

**Ready to talk? [brightworkrealty.com](https://brightworkrealty.com) · (925) 255-9727**

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Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: [relaunch.brightworkrealty.com](https://relaunch.brightworkrealty.com)



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## Important Notice

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